to Andhra. A few of the major edicts have not endured well: Sopara in Maharashtra has yielded fragments of a mere three edicts, while at Sannathi in Karnataka only four edicts have been found. Similarly at Kandahar, as we saw, a mere two edicts have survived on a single rectangular block of limestone. Interestingly, the edicts at all these places—Kandahar, Sopara, and Sannathi—are not inscribed into large *in situ* rocks but on dressed stone slabs. Unusually, in Sannathi, they cover both the front and back of the slabs, leading to the inference that the slab was vertically set up by the inscribers so that their inscriptions could be read. Ashoka's major rock edicts could sometimes be termed his major stone edicts.



Fig. 8.1: Part of the inscribed Kalsi rock in Uttarakhand as it appeared before a shed was built over it